Ford Motor Company

Service Recall Bulletin

June 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD - Safety Recall 00S17: Certain 2000 Model Year Explorer/Mountaineer – Side Airbag Crash Sensor Replacements

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2000 model year Explorer and Mountaineer 4-door vehicles with the side airbag option, built at the Louisville Assembly Plant from June 1, 2000 through June 22, 2000.

Certain 2000 model year Explorer vehicles with side airbag option, built at the St. Louis Assembly Plant from June 7, 2000 through June 23, 2000.

SAFETY CONCERN

The driver or passenger may experience an inadvertent side airbag deployment if they forcibly try to extract the seat belt (i.e. the belt locks up and the operator continues to pull sharply on the belt).

SERVICE ACTION

Dealers will replace both the driver and passenger side airbag crash sensors.
Do not drive, demonstrate, deliver or perform pre-delivery inspection on any vehicles affected by this recall until this repair has been performed.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information: 1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions: 1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,

Ann O'Neill

Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD - Safety Recall 00S17:
Certain 2000 Model Year Explorer/Mountaineer
Side Airbag Crash Sensor Replacements

OASIS

OASIS will be activated for this recall Thursday, June 29, 2000. You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $1,100 per vehicle.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer VIN list which you will receive in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). Also, correct other eligible vehicles which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

RENTAL CARS

Rental cars are authorized for sold units. Ford will pay for a rental vehicle for a maximum of seven (7) days except for fuel, which will be at the owner's expense. Follow Extended Service Plan (ESP) guidelines for rental dollar amounts. Enter the word "LOANER" plus the number of days the vehicle was used in the "Miscellaneous Expense" area of the recall claim.

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD - Safety Recall 00S17:
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Side Airbag Crash Sensor Replacements

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Replace Both Side Airbag Crash Sensors	00S17B	0.7 Hours
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hours

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. Order your parts requirement through the order processing channels as noted below:

All order types	Before August 1, 2000	Call 1-800-325-5621
All order types	On or after August 1, 2000	Normal order process

There are approximately 2,000 total vehicles involved in this recall.

Part Number	Description	Quantity
XL2Z-14B345-AB	Side Airbag Crash Sensor – 1 per package	2 per vehicle required

NOTE: Removed parts must be mutilated and properly scrapped to prevent their use on another vehicle.

ORDER INFORMATION DOR/COR

DOR/COR number 50168 identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the Recall Hotline (1-800-325-5621).

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

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Side Airbag Crash Sensor Replacements

Refer to the 2000 Explorer/Mountaineer workshop manual Group 5 Section 501-20B for side airbag crash sensor location and replacement instructions.

NOTE: Removed parts must be mutilated and properly scrapped to prevent their use on another vehicle.

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
1-800-392-3673
www.ownerconnection.com

June 2000

00S17

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is being sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect that relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 2000 model year Explorer and Mountaineer 4-door vehicles equipped with the side airbag option.

We apologize for this situation and want to assure you that with your assistance we will correct this condition. Our commitment, together with Ford and Lincoln Mercury dealers, is to provide you with the highest level of service and support possible.

What the safety issue is…	You or your passenger may experience an inadvertent side airbag deployment if you forcibly try to extract the seat belt (i.e. the belt locks up and you continue to pull sharply on the belt).
What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do...	Your dealer will replace both side airbag crash sensors. Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer for this service.
How long will it take?	The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.
What we are asking you to do…	Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date and whether parts are in stock for Safety Recall 00S17. If your dealer does not have the parts in stock, they can be ordered before scheduling your service date. Parts would be expected to arrive within a week after ordering. When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle…

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns…

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Assistance Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-800-424-9393 (Washington, D. C. area residents may call 1-202-366-0123).

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

QualityCare™ at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs